



◁ Grob G109B/Vigilant T1 1984

Origin Germany

Engine 95 hp Grob 2500E1
air-cooled flat-4

Top speed 140 mph (225 km/h)

Launched originally in 1980 this surprisingly rapid (when under power) motorized glider with a VW car-derived engine was adopted by the RAF for Air Cadet training in Vigilant T1 form.



△ ARV Super2 1985

Origin UK

Engine 77 hp Hewland AE75 2-stroke
liquid-cooled inverted 3-cylinder in-line

Top speed 118 mph (190 km/h)

World Land Speed record breaker Richard Noble conceived this low-cost, two-seat trainer, designed by Bruce Giddings. Two-stroke engine, and built from kits, just 35 were made.



△ Van's RV-6 1986

Origin USA

Engine 150-180 hp Lycoming AE10-360-
A1A air-cooled flat-4

Top speed 210 mph (338 km/h)

Since it was first flown in 1985 almost 2,500 of this all-aluminum two-seater have been sold in kit form. Designer Richard VanGrunsven aimed for good handling, high cruise speed, and STOL.

▷ Lancair 235 1986

Origin USA

Engine 118 hp Lycoming
O-235-L2A air-cooled flat-4

Top speed 242 mph (389 km/h)

Lance Neibauer's molded composite brainchild was a high-speed, two-seat private aircraft sold in kit form. Light weight and aerodynamics gave it great performance and it sold well.



△ Sequoia Falco F8L 1987

Origin UK built/Italian design

Engine 160 hp Lycoming O-320-B3B
air-cooled flat-4

Top speed 202 mph (325 km/h)

Designed in Italy in 1955 by Stelio Frati, the Falco was reborn in the 1980s in the US, selling in kit form. One of the fastest and most expensive homebuilt aircraft, it is renowned for its fine handling.

▷ Pegasus XL-R Microlight 1989

Origin UK

Engine 39 hp Rotax 447/462 2-stroke
liquid-cooled 2-cylinder in-line

Top speed 67 mph (108 km/h)

This flexwing Microlight could be flown solo or two-up and was well liked—it was considered easy to fly if somewhat slow in a headwind, with a cruise speed of about 45 mph (72 km/h).

